

CYBER RESILIENCE STARTER GUIDE

Five Practical Actions You Can Take Today

Cybercrime doesn't just target large organisations.

Every day, individuals, families, sole traders, small businesses and community organisations can be affected by scams, phishing, identity theft, account compromise, ransomware and online fraud.

Cybercriminals increasingly use artificial intelligence and other technologies to make scams and impersonation attempts more convincing.

The good news is that you don't need to be a cybersecurity expert to improve your cyber resilience.

Taking a few practical steps today can reduce your risk and make it easier to respond and recover if something goes wrong.

Cyber resilience isn't built during an incident; it's built before one happens.

1. Protect Your Accounts

- Use strong, unique passwords or passphrases.
- Use passkeys where they are available and appropriate.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on your email, banking and other important accounts.
- Use a reputable password manager where appropriate.
- Keep your account recovery information up to date.

Start with your email account. Access to your email can allow a cybercriminal to reset passwords and gain access to other accounts.

2. Secure Your Devices

- Keep your phone, tablet and computer updated.
- Enable a screen lock using a PIN, password or biometric protection.
- Enable device encryption where available.
- Turn on "Find My Device", "Find My" or equivalent recovery features.
- Only install apps from trusted sources and review app permissions periodically.

Your mobile phone deserves the same protection as your computer. For many people, it is now their primary device for email, banking, shopping and accessing important accounts.

3. Stop and Verify Before You Click

Cybercriminals increasingly use artificial intelligence to create convincing emails, text messages, websites, images, documents and cloned voices. They may impersonate people, businesses or organisations you trust.

Be particularly cautious when someone asks you to:

- Send money or make an investment
- Change bank account or payment details
- Provide a password, security code or personal information
- Click a link or open an unexpected attachment

- Act urgently or keep something secret

Before acting:

✓ STOP

Don't let urgency pressure you into acting immediately.

✓ CHECK

Look for anything unusual about the request.

✓ VERIFY INDEPENDENTLY

Contact the person or organisation using contact details you already trust—not the details provided in the suspicious message.

Don't let the message, caller or profile do the verifying.

4. Back Up What Matters

Protect important information such as:

- Family photos and videos
- Important personal or business documents
- Financial and tax records
- Other information that would be difficult or impossible to replace

Remember:

Cloud storage is useful—but synchronisation is not always the same as backup.

Maintain at least one independent backup of information that matters to you and periodically check that important files can be recovered.

5. Prepare Before Something Goes Wrong

Ask yourself:

- Would I know what to do if my email or social media account was compromised?
- Could I recover my important files if my device failed, was lost or was attacked?
- Who would I contact if I lost money or disclosed information to a scammer?
- Would I know how to contact my bank, IT provider or other important service provider?
- If I run a business, could I continue operating if an important system, vendor or communication service became unavailable?

Write down important contact details and keep them somewhere you can access even if your normal device or account is unavailable.

Preparation today can make recovery much easier tomorrow.

That final business-continuity question connects the Starter Guide with the expanded operational resilience material in Toolkits 2 and 3 without making the guide overly technical.

Want More Practical Help?

This guide is only the beginning.

I regularly share free videos covering scams, identity protection, online safety, cyber incidents and practical ways to strengthen cyber resilience.

 **Watch free Cyber Resilience videos on YouTube:** <https://www.youtube.com/@ThiaWComputing>



Take the Next Step

For those who want more structured, step-by-step guidance, the **Thia-W Cyber Resilience Toolkit Suite** provides practical checklists, templates, assessments and action planning tools.

Personal Cyber Safety Toolkit

Practical checklists and guidance to help individuals and families protect their accounts, devices, finances and personal information, recognise scams and strengthen their ability to recover when something goes wrong.

Small Business Cyber Resilience Toolkit

Practical checklists, assessments and templates to help sole traders, small businesses, not-for-profit organisations and community groups identify cyber risks, strengthen controls, improve backup and recovery, prepare for incidents and build operational resilience.

Secure Communications & Vendor Security Toolkit

Practical tools to help organisations strengthen business communications, verify high-risk requests, assess vendors and third parties, manage vendor dependencies and prepare for communication and vendor-related incidents.

Ready to take the next step?

Explore the complete Cyber Resilience Toolkit Suite:

<https://thiaw.com.au/cyber-resilience-toolkit-suite.html>

